

W.T. 1050/CX/7/43

BRITISH EMBASSY

WASHINGTON, D.C.

13th December, 1943.

Dear Mr. Pehle,

We have now received a reply from London to the telegram which we sent to them following our recent discussion on the subject of your proposals for the evacuation of Jews from Roumania and France.

This matter has evidently received very full and careful consideration in London. The Ministry of Economic Warfare inform us that from the purely financial angle, they would have been prepared to agree to the proposed licence for the transfer of \$25,000 on certain conditions which they would regard as necessary in view of the grave objections which they see in general to obtaining cash from residents in occupied territories against blocked credits in dollars or Swiss francs. They think it would be very difficult indeed to devise safeguards against Nazi agents and other objectionable persons using this scheme to their own advantage. However, I do not propose at this stage to set out in detail the conditions which they suggest, since they inform us that the Foreign Office sees grave disadvantages in general to the scheme and are telegraphing separately on the matter.

I expect very shortly to be in a position to put the views of the Foreign Office before you, but I am sending you this letter in the meanwhile since I know how urgently you wish to deal with this matter and I wanted to let you know that there appear to be certain political disadvantages involved.

Yours sincerely,

/s/ G. F. Thorold

Mr. J. Pehle,
U. S. Treasury Department,
Foreign Funds Control,
Washington, D. C.

CC - Messrs. Pehle, Schmidt, Fox, Luxford, DuBois, E. M. Bernstein

Miss Hodel.